

Sjors Verhaak

Curriculum Vitae
February 2026

EDUCATION

- Ph.D., Cornell University, Department of Government July 2026 (Expected)
Dissertation: *Imaginarities of Earth*
Committee: Patchen Markell (Chair), Jill Frank, Alex Livingston
Fields: Political Theory (Major), Comparative Politics (Minor)
- M.A., Cornell University, Department of Government August 2022
GPA: 3.90
- B.A., The Ohio State University, Department of Political Science May 2019
Honors Research Thesis: "Normative Demonstration in Constitutional Democracy: An Expression of Political Love-Recognition"
GPA: 3.852

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- Graduate Student Instructor, "First-Year Writing Seminar: Thinking Earth" (FA25)
Graduate Student Instructor, "FWS: Politics and Nature" (SP23)
Graduate Lecturer, "What Makes Us Human?" (WI23)
Teaching Assistant, "American Political Thought" (FA22)
Teaching Assistant, "What Makes Us Human?" (SU22, SU23, SU24, WI25, SU25, WI26)
Teaching Assistant, "The U.S. Constitution" (SP22)
Teaching Assistant, "Civil Disobedience" (FA21)
Teaching Assistant, "Introduction to Political Theory" (SP21)
Teaching Assistant, "Introduction to American Government and Politics" (FA20)

AWARDS/GRANTS/FELLOWSHIPS

- Sage Dissertation Completion Fellowship (Cornell, AY24–25)
Sage Fellowship (Cornell, AY19–20)
Pi Sigma Alpha Member (Political Science Honor Society, 2019)
Dean's List (OSU, 2017–2019)

CONFERENCES/WORKSHOPS

- Western Political Science Association Annual Meeting**
Paper Presenter, "Towards a Democratic Theory of Confluent Earth Politics"
(Scheduled for presentation, April 2026)

Association for Political Theory Conference

Paper Presenter, “Figures of Gaia: Planetary Thinking Beyond Systems Theory”
(Chicago, November 2025)

Cornell Faith & Environment Collective

Invited Presenter, “What makes a good environmentalist from a political perspective?”
(Ithaca, 2025)

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting

Paper Presenter, “Contestable Earth: On the Earth Community and the Rights of Nature
Movement” (Philadelphia, 2024)

Political Theory Workshop, Cornell University

Discussant, “Cis Goes Mainstream,” (Perry Zurn, 2024)

Discussant, “Radical Democratic Theory of Expertise in the Context of the
Anthropocene” (Ari-Elmeri Hyvönen, 2022)

Discussant, “With or against the State? Feminism, Prison Abolition, and the Pursuit of
Justice” (Anna Terwiel, 2022)

Discussant, “The Nomos of the Eaarth [Sic]: Schmitt, Latour, and the Politics of
Planetary Habitability” (Dan Zimmer, 2020)

SERVICE AND OTHER EMPLOYMENT

International Relations Minor and Migration Studies Minor Coordinator (AY23-24)

Coordinated advising and administrative support for undergraduate minors in
International Relations and Migration Studies; assisted with curriculum planning, course
scheduling, and student outreach; organized minor-related events and facilitated
communication between faculty and administrative staff.

LANGUAGES

English (native)

German, Dutch, and Latin (academic reading proficiency)